
The Pitt Prides Itself on Accuracy. So How Did It Mess This Up?

Published by

Hillary Frey

Estimated reading time

4 min

Added on

2026-04-20

Address

<https://slate.com/culture/2026/04/the-pitt-season-2-finale-robb-baby-noah-wyle-swaddle-parenting.html>

The Pitt Prides Itself on Accuracy. So How Did It Mess This Up?

In the last moments of the finale of *The Pitt*'s second season, which aired Thursday night, Dr. Robby (Noah Wyle) is alone in a quiet peds (pediatric) room with a baby who was left in the ER waiting area early that morning. It's an outrageously tender scene, and any watcher is hoping that this little baby girl, abandoned by her parents, will somehow enchant Robby enough to ditch his plan to drive his motorcycle, helmetless, on what sounds like a literal suicide mission across the country and take her home with him as a foster parent. Perhaps everyone could win here: Robby will have someone to love, and this perfect baby will have a guardian.

It's very touching. But the scene also features a pretty wild mistake: Dr. Robby cannot swaddle a baby to save his life.

This wouldn't matter, except for two things. The first is simply that Dr. Robby says to the baby: "Why are you crying? Why are you crying, little one? You're safe. You're not alone. You're OK. Do you need to be swaddled again?" He then starts limply folding the blanket over the baby in a loose and haphazard way. This would be fine if he were just putting the blanket around the baby to pick her up. But he said he was going to swaddle her. This is not what he does!

If you are a parent who has had a kid in the past 20 years (or maybe earlier—I can't speak to whether the craze goes back that far), you know the difference between a loose wrap and a real, bona fide swaddle. When my older friends had kids in the early aughts, they were all reading [The Happiest Baby on the Block](#), a book that endorsed the "Five S's" to calm your baby to sleep, one of which was swaddling. Swaddling is no joke; you have to put your tiny, tiny baby in a straitjacket of your own design. You are origami-ing them into submission. Experts tell you that this is good, but it initially seems bad. It is scary putting their little arms by their sides and immobilizing them with a pretty muslin cloth pulled tighter than seems OK, and then extremely satisfying when you master it and your baby conks out. I took a lot of pride in my extremely snug swaddles—this skill was overshadowed only by my ability to cut my baby's fingernails without nicking her. My ex-husband was even better. We were sad when our little daughter was finally strong enough to break out of our custom cocoon; it was harder for everyone to sleep, and it was a goodbye to her earliest weeks and months. (She's 14 now and sleeps with a "burrito blanket" and buried in fluffy throws, which I guess is like a teen swaddle.)

Why does this matter in the context of *The Pitt*? Why am I beating up on the near-unimpeachable Wyle? Because this is a show that [prides itself on accuracy](#), crow's about it, lives by it. Earlier in the episode, Robby performs a C-section on a mom whose life—as well as that of her baby—is in danger. We see it all; every move, instruction, and gruesome slice is precise. Even medical professionals have [praised the series](#) for how accurately it depicts everyday and extraordinary traumas in the ER. Nothing on this jargon-filled, extremely graphic show is sloppy, ever. So why, in the big send-off to the season, did *The Pitt* whiff it on the swaddle? C'mon!

My ex-husband texted me this morning, in all caps: "THE SWADDLE WAS BAD" and surmised that Wyle's wife (and the partners of the other men at the helm of the show) must have taken care of the kids, at least when they were babies. A co-worker texted that her husband immediately noted the "shit swaddle." I really hope that when we see Robby again, he's 1) alive and 2) caring for this baby. But I also hope, in the meantime, he has learned how to properly swaddle. And maybe he'll [get swaddled himself](#)—he needs it.

Get the best of culture

Get the best of movies, TV, books, music, and more.

Thanks for signing up! You can [manage your newsletter subscriptions](#) at any time.

You're already subscribed to the Culture newsletter. You can [manage your newsletter subscriptions](#) at any time.

We encountered an issue signing you up. Please try again, or [manage all your newsletter subscriptions here](#) .

Please enable javascript to sign up for newsletters.

Email address:

Send me updates about Slate special offers.

By signing up, you agree to our [Privacy Policy](#) and [Terms](#).

Sign Up

Produced by wallabag with tcpdf

Please open [an issue](#) if you have trouble with the display of this E-Book on your device.